Little Red Riding Hood

By Billy Aronson

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Singing Intro from Sam The Sham & The Pharaohs
Listen to the Lyrics at the following link:
http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_FA85RO89HA

Owooooooooo!
Who's that I see walkin' in these woods?
Why, it's Little Red Riding Hood.
Hey there Little Red Riding Hood,
You sure are looking good.
You're everything a big bad wolf could want.
Listen to me.

Little Red Riding Hood
I don't think little big girls should
Go walking in these spooky old woods alone.
Owooooooooo!

INTRODUCTION

Actress: *Little Red Riding Hood . . . . .*
Actor: *the contemporary version*
Together: *by Billy Aronson*

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SCENE 1

LITTLE RED RIDING HOOD and her MOTHER.

MOTHER: This fresh fruit pie should help make Grandmom strong again, don't you think,

Red?

RED: Yes, Mother.

MOTHER: Let's add a warm muffin for the woman who made my bed and kissed me goodnight.

RED: Yes, Mother.

MOTHER: Let's stuff the muffin with a stone so she'll choke. That woman said I was worthless, Red.

RED: I understand, Mother.

MOTHER: But she sure could soothe me to sleep with a bedtime story. So lean Grandmom forward and pat her back 'til she coughs up the stone.

RED: Yes, Mother.

MOTHER: Apologize to the woman who gave birth to your Mother. Then smash her head with a chair.

RED: Yes, Mother.

MOTHER: On second thought, it would be a shame to smash Grandmom when she's already suffering so. Let's wait 'til she's feeling better to choke her and smash her. For now just bring her the goodies.

RED: Yes, Mother.

MOTHER: Stay on the open path the whole way, don't wander into the woods.

RED: I won't, Mother.

MOTHER: If a stranger pokes his head out ignore him. Eyes ahead. Face down. What's that ugly frown? We're talking about keeping the stranger at a distance, not disgusting him.

RED: All right, Mother.

MOTHER: What are we saying. You're too young to talk to strangers. Go straight to Grandmom's.

RED: All right, Mother. Bye, Bye! [RED *exits.]*

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MOTHER: I knew one day she'd leave.

SCENE 2

LITTLE RED RIDING HOOD and the BIG BAD WOLF

WOLF: Nice hat. You from around here?

RED: Yeah.

WOLF: It's a pretty area.

RED: Your woods seem nice. You call it woods or wood?

WOLF: Woods, wood, forest ... Don't ask me what a thicket is. Come sit in the shade.

RED: No thanks.

WOLF: I like your basket.

RED: It's my Mom's.

WOLF: Can I see?

RED: I have to get to my Grandmother's.

WOLF: That's your Grandmother? Down at the end of the road, right at the fork?

RED: Left-

WOLF: Yeah, left, 'til you pass the lake

RED: Right before the lake.

WOLF: What's the number on her door .. .?

RED: Four.

WOLF: Right. Sweet woman.

RED: She's been sick.

WOLF: She has seemed kind of unwell.

RED: Does your face sweat a lot?

WOLF: No more than yours.

RED: How far out do your claws come?

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WOLF: Tah dah.

RED: Gleaming needles.

WOLF: I keep them clean.

RED: They're so long.

WOLF: Thank you.

RED: I've never seen such big teeth.

WOLF: I've never seen such smooth bare hands. How do you make them glow like that?

RED: I don't know. [RED *slaps her ankle.]* Mosquito.

WOLF: I'll scratch it for you.

RED: No thanks.

WOLF: It's the least I can do. You wouldn't have been bitten if you hadn't stopped to talk with me. When you scratch yourself you can't fully enjoy the relief. Let me have your leg. Come on. Pull up the cape. Up, I don't want to tear it. Slide down the sock. Relax.

RED: OW. Ee.

WOLF: Now with the teeth.

RED: Ooo-Stop. Someone could see. What would ...

WOLF: You're right. Your face is as red as your hood.

RED: That's the way it goes.

WOLF: SO how about a tour of the woods?

RED: Oh no.

WOLF: You're sure?

RED: I have to get to Grandmom's house.

WOLF: I should be going too. But let me give you some advice. You walk too fast. Take some time to admire all the beautiful flowers along the path. Pick your Grandmother a bouquet. [WOLF *goes.* RED *plucks flowers.]*

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SCENE 3

The HUNTER sits, is served by the MOTHER.

HUNTER: Where's my slab O' steak?

MOTHER: Coming dear.

HUNTER: If a hunter doesn't have his slab O' steak he can't grab his gun and if he can't grab his gun he can't blast the beasts and if he can't blast the beasts how's he gonna market their meats if he can't market their meats there's no way he can house his spouse and if he can't house his spouse then where's he supposed to eat his slab O' steak, in the gosh darn mud crap slop?

MOTHER: You didn't get one of your arms into your shirt, dear.

HUNTER: Sure you miss a sleeve now and then or sometimes you forget to button a few buttons, but what about the sleeve you did get into the shirt, what about the buttons you did button. I'm sick and tired of people who always focus on the empty sleeve or the unbuttoned button-

MOTHER: Your fly's open.

HUNTER: -or the opened fly, when the fact is if the truth be known when push comes to shove it's the people with the unbuttoned buttons and unsleeved arms who are out there not looking at the lookers who are looking at them but just plain out there being out there. I'm out there.

MOTHER: I know you're out there, dear.

HUNTER: I'm the one who faces the heat and the snow and the dirtand let me tell you it gets dirty-so I can brave the hills and the lakes and the pebbles-which inevitably get in your boots-to grapple with the branches and the ragweed and the pollen-'til I'm sneezin' my head off-

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MOTHER: There's grease on your nose and steak on your forehead, and your fork is lodged behind your ear.

HUNTER: What's a drop O' grease on a hunter's nose for the sake of his home, or a fork in his ear for his family? I love this fork and I love this family and let me tell you something, sister, I may have a slab of greasy beef suspended from my brow but that won't stop me from pumping ten ounces of lead into a fat quadruped at close range because it's a dog eat dog jungle in that forest.

SCENE 4

GRANDMOTHER in her bed.

GRANDMOTHER: Yecch. *[Spits.]* I'm spitting up my rotten guts. Where's my lousy bowl. Have to crawl to the cupboard on my throbbing knees. Can't open the latch with my cracked-up knuckles. Back to the bed for that worthless ointment. Can't grip the cap in my rotten wrecked-up teeth, where's my busted tweezers. Lousy bowl was right here the whole time. Useless eyes. Yecch. *[Spits.]* Missed. *[A knock at the door.]*

GRANDMOTHER: Knock knock yourself.

WOLF: It's Little Red Riding Hood with a snack from Mother.

GRANDMOTHER: Couldn't keep down a snack if I wanted to.

WOLF: There's a pie and a muffin ...

GRANDMOTHER: Leave me alone.

WOLF: and some wine ...

GRANDMOTHER: Get in here. 'Snot locked. [WOLF *enters.]*

WOLF: Into the closet. I'm here to eat your Granddaughter.

GRANDMOTHER: You discriminate against the aged?

WOLF: I'll eat you later.

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GRANDMOTHER: Right now, or I don't budge.

WOLF: Sorry but I'm going to relax now, to get ready for Little Red.

GRANDMOTHER: You could put an end to every ache in my body in an instant and I demand you do it.

WOLF: I'm a wolf, not a charity worker. I'll get to you when I feel like it.

GRANDMOTHER: You'll never eat me, I know it. I'll keep getting more dumb and decrepit 'til there isn't a tooth left in my-ocean? teaspoon? and I can't even get myself up out of the-soldier? celery?-Oh stitch. I'm losing my ability to think of the right word to plant.

WOLF: Old ladies are a pain Okay, I'll eat you if . . . if you hand me your shawl.

GRANDMOTHER: *[She hands him her shawl, crawls under the sheets. WOLF crawls under, eats her, emerges in her shawl.]*

SCENE 5

RED and the WOLF.

RED: Grandmom?

WOLF: Come on in, honey. Shut the door. Get comfy. [Removes Shawl] Surprise.

RED: Hi.

WOLF: Hi.

RED: How've you been?

WOLF: Thinking about you. How have you been?

RED: Since Grandmom's gone we can have a muffin.

WOLF: I would love a muffin.

RED: Okay.

WOLF: How'd it get smushed?

RED: My Mother put a stone in and took it out again.

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WOLF: Why'd she do that? Anyway, it's a delicious muffin.

RED: You looked weird in Grandmom's shawl.

WOLF: Did I surprise you?

RED: Uh, no.

WOLF: I was afraid if you saw me right when you walked in you might run. You seemed so bashful before.

RED: I picked flowers like you said.

WOLF: Very pretty.

RED: When I'm in your stomach will I be alive?

WOLF: You'll be unconscious.

RED: For how long?

WOLF: A few minutes. Then you run out of air. But you won't feel anything at that point.

RED: No one's woken up and couldn't breathe?

WOLF: Not that I know of.

RED: Couldn't you kill me with your teeth on the way in?

WOLF: It's better for me if I swallow you whole. And for you too. Less mess.

RED: Should I get undressed?

WOLF: Just take off your shoes.

RED: How was Grandmom?

WOLF: I prefer kids.

RED: Now I'm scared.

WOLF: Don't be. *[He eats her .falls asleep.]*

SCENE 6

The HUNTER enters followed by the MOTHER.

MOTHER: She always comes straight home.

HUNTER: Would you pipe the heck down with your pointless panic before you work

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yourself up-See? There's her basket and her shoes and the Wolf [into a frenzy.] Help! Wolf! Help! Wolf!.

MOTHER: You've got a gun, he doesn't have a gun. And besides he's fast asleep.

HUNTER: Right. I'm in the perfect position to blast the biggest beast in the forest with the flick of a finger.

MOTHER: Let me cut Little Red from his belly first.

HUNTER: The Big Bad Wolf is mine. Oh yes. Oh good. Oh very good. [HUNTER *sings, as* MOTHER *pulls* RED *and* GRANDMOTHER *from the* WOLF's *belly and embraces them.]*

HUNTER: C'mon, Wolf. Arise and be blasted. *[The* HUNTER *shoots several times until the entire room is blasted to bits and the stage is filled with smoke.]* Got him. Probably.

EPILOGUE

RED pursues the WOLF.

RED: Please eat me again, Mister Wolf. I'll just curl into a little ball and slide right down. Let me in, please please?

WOLF: I can't eat you. I'm dead. So I've really got to be moving on.

RED: Eat me first?

WOLF: No time. Sorry.

RED: It's not fair.

WOLF: Tell me about it.

RED: So what do I do.

WOLF: Live happily ever after, I guess.

RED: Huh.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Billy Aronson
Book: The Best American Short Plays 1992-1993
ISBN: 978-1557831675
Publisher: Applause Books
Date (Month/Year): May 2000

AWARD HISTORY

2005 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier

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